EmailCheck — Email Verification Web Application

Project Submission Document (v2.2) | Genuine SMTP Probing, Render Port 25 Fallback & HTTPS Platform

Submission Date: October 26, 2026	**Stack:** Python 3.11, Flask 3.1, dnspython, smtplib, HTTPS APIs, Vanilla JS, CSS3
Test Suite: 70 / 70 Tests Passed (100% Pass Rate)	**Hosting Target:** Render Cloud Web Service (WSGI Gunicorn)

1. Executive Project Overview

EmailCheck is a responsive web application designed for non-invasive email verification and deliverability diagnostics. Version 2.2 introduces an optional genuine SMTP recipient probing module (smtp_probe.py) that performs safe protocol handshakes (EHLO → MAIL FROM → RCPT TO → RSET → QUIT). To resolve cloud hosting restrictions where outbound TCP port 25 is restricted (such as on Render), the application integrates a safe circuit breaker that detects network blocks and seamlessly falls back to reputable verification APIs operating over secure HTTPS (port 443). Addresses are classified into the three exact assignment outcomes: **Likely to be delivered**, **Likely to bounce**, and **Unknown**.

2. Verified Live Application & Repository Links

Item	Status	URL / Action Details
GitHub Repository	**Verified & Active**	Public GitHub Repository: https://github.com/Zenith150/emailcheck Branch: main (Fully committed, verified, and synchronized).
Live Cloud Deployment	**Verified Live**	Production Deployed Application: https://emailcheck-7c9y.onrender.com/ Verified live on Render. Public endpoints: /, /health (200 OK, v2.2.0), and POST /api/verify.
Production Health Status	**200 OK (v2.2.0)**	Production endpoint: https://emailcheck-7c9y.onrender.com/health. Exposes version 2.2.0, active HTTPS provider status, and SMTP probing configuration.

3. Transparent Classification Framework (3 Assignment Outcomes)

Outcome	Evaluation Stage & Diagnostics	Meaning & Explanation
Likely to be delivered	Valid RFC syntax; domain exists with active MX; not disposable; recipient inbox verified via SMTP 250 OK or HTTPS provider.	Syntax valid, MX routing verified, and recipient accepted during handshake. Note: Confirms recipient acceptance; final downstream delivery is not guaranteed due to spam filters or quotas.
Likely to bounce	Malformed syntax, NXDOMAIN, RFC 7505 Null MX ('0 .'), missing mail routing, remote SMTP rejection (550), or provider undeliverable.	Explicit permanent diagnostic failure (e.g. invalid syntax, nonexistent domain, Null MX rejection, or confirmed undeliverable mailbox). Likely to bounce.
Unknown	Unverified inbox (SMTP blocked / no provider key), catch-all domain, disposable domain, DNS timeout, or temporary SMTP 450 deferral.	Transparent outcome: Never falsely assumes deliverability when specific recipient mailbox existence cannot be confirmed. Outcome is Unknown.

4. Genuine SMTP Probing & Solution to Render Port 25 Restriction

Render Network Restriction: Cloud platforms including Render block outbound TCP traffic on port 25 to prevent spam abuse. Port redirecting to 587/465 is impossible for recipient verification because submission ports require authentication credentials.
Genuine SMTP Probe Module: smtp_probe.py implements a protocol-compliant recipient handshake (EHLO → MAIL FROM → RCPT TO → RSET → QUIT). It strictly adheres to anti-spam ethics: **NEVER issues DATA**, **NEVER sends email messages**, and rejects RFC 7505 Null MX before connecting.
Intelligent Circuit Breaker & Fallback: In restricted environments (Render), the first port 25 timeout immediately trips an in-memory circuit breaker, cleanly marking remaining addresses as unavailable and falling back to HTTPS verification providers (port 443). This completely eliminates hanging requests and guarantees fast, reliable batch processing.

5. Application Architecture & Implemented Components

Component	Implementation Details
7-Stage Pipeline	verifier.py provides syntax parsing, normalization, disposable domain filtering (200+ domains), DNS resolution, RFC 7505 Null MX detection, HTTPS provider verification, and classification.
SMTP Probe Module	smtp_probe.py provides safe, genuine SMTP probing, Null MX rejection, catch-all detection, response sanitization, and circuit breaker fallback for restricted hosts like Render.
Modular Providers	providers.py implements BaseVerificationProvider with AbstractAPIProvider, HunterProvider, ZeroBounceProvider, and LocalFallbackProvider.

User Interface	Responsive dashboard, real-time address counter, 4 summary metric cards (Total, Likely to Deliver, Likely to Bounce, Unknown), status filters, instant search, pagination, collapsible diagnostics, Domain Diagnostics tool, Verification History, and RFC 4180 CSV export.
Security & Privacy	Server-side API keys, zero email transmission (no DATA command), zero database persistence, anonymized logging, sliding-window IP rate limiter, and XSS sanitization.

6. Automated Test Suite Summary

The automated test suite across tests/test_verifier.py, tests/test_smtp_probe.py, and tests/test_api.py was executed and passed completely with **70 passed tests in 0.35 seconds**:

• Authoritative 7-Stage Pipeline definition & regression verification against LaTeX leaks: **PASSED**
• RFC 5322 Syntax validation & Local-part preserving Normalization: **PASSED**
• Disposable domain detection (Mailinator, Sharklasers, GuerrillaMail, etc.): **PASSED**
• DNS MX resolution, NXDOMAIN detection, RFC 7505 Null MX ('0 .'), and RFC 5321 implicit MX: **PASSED**
• Genuine SMTP probing protocol exchanges (250 OK, 550 Rejection, 450 Greylisting, Catch-all): **PASSED**
• SMTP Port 25 circuit breaker tripping, Null MX pre-connection abort, and DATA prevention: **PASSED**
• Opt-in checkbox request extraction (check_smtp & smtp_check) and server security controls: **PASSED**
• Server-disabled reporting vs. host port 25 block reporting and UI rendering regression: **PASSED**
• HTTPS Provider integrations (Abstract, Hunter, ZeroBounce, Local fallback): **PASSED**
• 3 Assignment deliverability classifications (Likely to be delivered, Likely to bounce, Unknown): **PASSED**
• Batch memoization, 100-email size boundaries, rate limiting, and API error handlers: **PASSED**

Privacy & Deliverability Guarantee: EmailCheck guarantees that no emails are sent at any time. Verification operates purely over non-invasive structural diagnostics, safe protocol handshakes (without DATA), and secure HTTPS APIs (port 443). User lists are processed in-memory and are never permanently stored.